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When a woman has received an ox heart on two occasions, she in turn prepares a feast. First she breaks amarula nuts, removes and crushes the kernels, and makes an oil dressing in which to cook chickens. If there are no amarula nuts, she may substitute omunghete nuts (Ricinodendron rautaneii Schinz). In addition to preparing the chickens, she makes beer. Then she summons her male cousin and gives him and the guests who come with him a meal of porridge, chickens, and beer. If the feast is a success, the guests comment on the way home:

Tuile kosivilo. Tuadjako tuakuta.
 Omuu uboli omulumenu. Esi kujandjela.
 Kesi umue ekuelilifa ngaha.
 Komunue fie otuapandula ngaha.
 We have been to [a] feast. We had enough.
 [That] person, she is [a] Big Woman. She knows how to hand
 out food.
 Everyone had enough anyway.
 To her we are thankful anyway.

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Parallel cousins call one another brother and sister and act as though they were brother and sister. If a man should sleep with (either bundle with or have sexual intercourse with) a "sister," he would be called mad and in former times would have been put to death. Even a king's son, not being of the royal clan, would have been exiled. A member of the royal clan (an ohamba) was exempt from this law.

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Although the Kuanyama do not now approve of cross-cousin marriages, traces of the custom remain in speech and action. For instance, customs, proverbs, and relationship terms appear to indicate that paternal cross-cousin marriage was preferred to maternal cross-cousin marriage; the Kuanyama proverb, "Ka xe kodule kaujoko" (Your father is more than your mother) may have been originally an expression of this preference. It is common practice, moreover, for two cross-cousins of opposite sexes to joke with each other and call each other "bull" (ohmedi). A man will say, "Oh, you are my bull. Now we will get married!" The relationship between a youth and his father's sister's daughter is intimately connected with the moon. The moon commonly is called ohani, but it (and moonlight) may be called omuedi (bull-person).

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Sckär writes,

"When the sickle of the new moon appears for the first time, the people rejoice and make offerings of mopane leaves, believing, as the Bushmen do, that the moon has died and come to life again.¹⁴ Everyone prays for favors from the new moon (okamuedjona, little-bull-woman, or okahani kovalodi, little moon of witches). A person will pray for wealth, cattle, or love. If one wishes to harm an enemy, one might also pray for this favor. The full moon which brings the fulfillment of wishes is celebrated with much more dancing and merrymaking."¹⁵

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14. The mopane tree ([Copaifera mopane](#) Kirk.) is called omufiati (dead man) by the Kuanyama. Its leaves are believed to make a dead person come to life. Hence they bring life to the moon.

15. Sckär, manuscript.

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